



STUDY GUIDE

Panel Panic (ART)

Category Overview

Every character has a story. Every story needs a character worth following.

Panel Panic challenges delegates to build a character from the ground up and then place them into a world of their own. From the first sketch to the final panel, participants will have to think about personality, expression, visual identity, storytelling, pacing, and composition. This category is split across two rounds. The first is about creating a character that feels original and memorable. The second is about taking that character beyond a single image and turning them into the centre of a complete comic.

Your character is only the beginning. What you do with them is where the story starts.

Round 1: Character Creation

Day 1 - Maximum 5 hours

Delegates are to create an original character on a single A4 sized sheet. The character should communicate a distinct personality and visual identity through their appearance, clothing, expressions, pose, and overall design.

The completed character from Round 1 will be carried forward into Round 2.

Round 2: Comic Creation

Days 2 and 3 | Maximum 9 hours

Delegates are to create an original comic featuring the character developed in Round 1.

The comic must contain a minimum of 2 pages and a maximum of 4 pages, with each page being A4 sized. Delegates are responsible for developing the story, dialogue, panel layouts, characters, environments, and visual direction of their comic. The final submission should communicate a coherent narrative from beginning to end.

Judging Criteria

- (15) Character Design - How distinctive, original, and visually effective is the character created in Round 1?
- (20) Visual Storytelling - How effectively does the comic communicate its narrative through imagery, expressions, actions, and panels?
- (15) Composition - How effectively are the panels, characters, backgrounds, text, and visual elements arranged?
- (15) Originality - How creative and individual is the overall concept, character, and story?
- (10) Technical Execution - How effectively are the chosen artistic techniques and medium used?

(75 marks total)



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Rules

- This is an individual category. Delegations may register as many people as they like, but every participant must work independently.
- Round 1 must be completed on a single A4 sized sheet.
- Round 2 must contain a minimum of 2 pages and a maximum of 4 pages, with each page being A4 sized.
- The character created in Round 1 must be incorporated into the comic created in Round 2.
- Delegates using traditional media are allotted a maximum of 5 hours for Round 1 and 9 hours for Round 2.
- Delegates using digital media are allotted the same time limits and must submit complete timelapses along with their submissions.
- Delegates are free to allocate and use their allotted time as they please.
- Delegates may use references, provided that all references are submitted to the category heads.
- All delegates are expected to bring their own materials and equipment.
- Work must be submitted to the category heads when delegates are not actively working on it.
- All artwork must be the delegate's own original work.
- Depictions of profane, sexual, violent, or explicit content may result in disqualification and or disciplinary action at the sole discretion of the equity board.